

SMART INDIA HACKATHON (SIH) 2026

Participants Rulebook

Institutional / Internal SIH Selection Process

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Document Governance

Applicability: This rulebook defines the institutional rules, procedures, and participant expectations applicable to the SIH 2026 internal selection process.

In case of any conflict between this institutional rulebook and the latest official SIH guidelines, the latest official SIH guidelines shall prevail.

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1. Overview

1.1 Smart India Hackathon (SIH) 2026

Smart India Hackathon (SIH) is a nationwide initiative designed to engage students in solving real-world challenges through innovation, practical problem-solving, and technology. The institutional selection process provides participating teams with an opportunity to develop and present solution ideas for selected problem statements.

1.2 Purpose of this Rulebook

This rulebook establishes a common set of expectations for participants covering registration, team formation, idea submission, presentation, attendance, evaluation, conduct, intellectual property, responsible technology use, and disciplinary procedures.

2. Participant Eligibility & General Requirements

- 2.1 Every participant must belong to **only one** team.
- 2.2 All participants must be from the Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Coimbatore Campus.
- 2.3 Members from different branches or schools may form a team.
- 2.4 Participants must carry their valid institutional ID card at all SIH-related activities.
- 2.5 Participants shall comply with the prescribed institutional dress code wherever applicable.

3. Team Formation

- 3.1 Teams may be multidisciplinary wherever applicable.
- 3.2 Each team shall designate one Team Leader who will serve as the primary point of contact for official communication and submission coordination.
- 3.3 Each team must consist of 6 members, including the Team Leader, and must include at least one female member.
- 3.4 Each team must have a designated faculty mentor.
- 3.5 Team members are expected to contribute meaningfully to the development, documentation, presentation, and validation of the proposed solution.

4. Idea Submission

- 4.1 Teams must submit only original ideas and solutions.
- 4.2 The submitted idea must address the selected problem statement effectively and demonstrate a clear understanding of the stated challenge.
- 4.3 Signed team declaration forms and all required presentation/submission materials must be submitted before the announced deadline.
- 4.4 The prescribed presentation template provided through the official SIH channel shall be used.

4.5 Responsible Use of Generative AI

Generative AI tools may be used as supporting tools for brainstorming, research, coding assistance, documentation, or refinement, where permitted. Participants remain fully responsible for the originality, accuracy, security, legality, and functionality of their submitted work.

- Teams must understand, verify, test, and take responsibility for any AI-assisted content or code incorporated into their solution.
- Direct submission of AI-generated content without meaningful team contribution, understanding, and verification may be treated as academic/professional misconduct.
- Participants shall not submit confidential, proprietary, personal, or restricted institutional information to external AI services.

5. Presentation Rules

- 5.1 Teams must identify and verify their allotted venues for presentation.
- 5.2 Teams must report to the assigned venue **at least 30 minutes** before their allotted presentation time.
- 5.3 The submitted PPT will be displayed by the designated SIH volunteer in the assigned presentation hall/class. Teams are strongly advised to carry a backup copy of the final submitted PPT on an additional storage device.
- 5.4 Teams must complete their presentation within the allotted time.
- 5.5 Teams should not directly present or demonstrate the developed prototype to judges during the presentation slot unless specifically permitted by the Organizing Committee. Screenshots, images, architecture diagrams, workflow illustrations, or recorded demonstrations may be included in the presentation where appropriate.
- 5.6 The duration for each team is 15 minutes (comprising 10 minutes for presentation and 5 minutes for judges' interaction).
- 5.7 Formal/official attire is mandatory during presentations, evaluations, inauguration, and other activities specifically notified by the Organizing Committee.

5.8 Technical Contingency

Teams are responsible for ensuring that their submitted presentation files are complete and compatible with the venue's display system. Teams should maintain at least one backup copy. Technical issues arising from team-owned devices or files shall not automatically entitle a team to additional presentation time. Venue-wide technical issues will be handled at the discretion of the Organizing Committee.

6. Attendance & Participation

- 6.1 All team members shall be present on the day of the presentation.
- 6.2 Any absence shall be formally reported to the Organizing Committee and supported by a letter duly signed by the respective Class Advisor or Team Mentor. Failure to do so may result in appropriate action.
- 6.3 Absence of key team members without prior approval may affect evaluation.
- 6.4 Each team member present at the venue during presentation shall sign the attendance sheet, which will be used for On-Duty (OD) processing.
- 6.5 Team withdrawal or voluntary change of team members after the notified deadline will generally not be permitted. Exceptions may be considered by the Organizing Committee in genuine emergencies or circumstances beyond the participant's control.

7. Evaluation

- 7.1 The decision of the judging panel shall be final and binding, subject to the applicable official SIH process.
- 7.2 Scores will be awarded based on the applicable official SIH evaluation criteria.
- 7.3 Participants shall not attempt to influence, solicit, or privately approach judges regarding evaluation or scores.
- 7.4 Any known conflict of interest involving a judge or evaluator should be brought to the attention of the Organizing Committee before evaluation.

7.5 Requests for reconsideration shall ordinarily not be entertained after results are announced, except where a demonstrable procedural error is identified and the Organizing Committee decides that review is appropriate.

8. Code of Conduct

- 8.1 Participants shall maintain professional and respectful behaviour throughout the event.
- 8.2 Respect towards judges, faculty members, volunteers, organizers, and fellow participants is mandatory.
- 8.3 Any form of harassment, discrimination, bullying, intimidation, threats, or abusive behaviour is prohibited and may result in disciplinary action.
- 8.4 Mobile phones shall be kept on silent mode during presentations and evaluation sessions.
- 8.5 Participants must maintain cleanliness, discipline, and responsible use of campus facilities.
- 8.6 Unauthorized photography or videography in restricted areas is prohibited.
- 8.7 Any damage to college property or event infrastructure may result in disciplinary action and recovery of applicable costs.
- 8.8 Participants shall comply with reasonable instructions issued by the Organizing Committee throughout the event.

8.9 Cybersecurity & Ethical Technology Use

Participants shall use technology responsibly and only within authorized environments. Unauthorized scanning, exploitation, denial-of-service activity, credential attacks, data extraction, or other security testing against institutional systems, networks, websites, or third-party infrastructure is prohibited. Security testing shall be restricted to explicitly authorized environments.

9. Disqualification & Disciplinary Measures

A team or participant may be subject to disciplinary action, removal from the event, or disqualification for serious or repeated violations, including:

- 9.1 Submitting plagiarized or copied work.
- 9.2 Providing false or misleading information during registration, submission, or evaluation.
- 9.3 Violating applicable SIH or institutional rules.
- 9.4 Engaging in unethical, abusive, threatening, or disruptive behaviour.
- 9.5 Failing to adhere to notified submission or presentation deadlines without an approved exception.
- 9.6 Deliberately obstructing, intimidating, abusing, or interfering with the Organizing Committee or event operations.

9.7 Disciplinary Authority

The Organizing Committee shall have the authority to review reported violations and take proportionate action based on their nature and severity. Actions may include a warning, removal from a venue, withholding of participation privileges, or disqualification of the concerned participant or team.

10. Communication & Important Instructions

- 10.1 The Organizing Committee reserves the right to modify the schedule, venue, procedure, or guidelines when required for the effective conduct of the event.
- 10.2 Announcements issued by the designated SIH Coordinators/Organizing Committee through official communication channels shall be treated as official instructions.

- 10.3** Participants are responsible for regularly checking their registered email and designated official communication channels for updates.
- 10.4** Information circulated through unofficial student groups shall not be treated as an official instruction unless subsequently confirmed through an official communication channel.
- 10.5** If a team qualifies in the Internal Hackathon, the team shall complete all subsequent procedures and portal submissions as directed by the SIH Core Team.
- 10.6** Participants are responsible for meeting all deadlines, maintaining submission backups, and ensuring that the Organizing Committee has accurate contact information for the Team Leader.

11. Participant Acknowledgement

By participating in the SIH 2026 institutional selection process, each participant acknowledges that they have read, understood, and agreed to comply with this rulebook, the applicable institutional policies, and the latest official SIH guidelines communicated by the Organizing Committee.

Team Name	<u>Pixels</u>
Team Leader	<u>RAVISHANMUGAM K</u>
Date	<u>31.08.2026</u>
Team Leader Signature	<u>V. Ravishanmugam</u>